



Jamaica Constabulary Force

Agricultural Protection Branch Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

Title: Jamaica Constabulary Force Agricultural Protection Branch Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Identification Code: JCF/FW/PL/Ops/0001/2025
Force Orders Publication F.O. No. 4057 dated 2025-03-06	Pages: 10
Last Reviewed: Nil	Distribution: Force-wide
Revision #: 0	Process Owner: DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio
Rescinds: Nil	
Authors: ACP Strategic Operations, PRDB	Owner: JCF
First Published: F.O. No. 4057 dated 2025-03-06	Review: Biennially

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1.0 Introduction

Agriculture has historically been a cornerstone of Jamaica's economy, contributing significantly to Gross Domestic Product (GDP), employment and foreign exchange earnings. However, the sector has faced challenges, particularly from agricultural related and organized crimes where both large and small-scale farmers experience theft of livestock, crops and equipment. These factors along with environmental disasters threaten the viability of agriculture in Jamaica, contributes to increased rate of criminal activities and disrupts peace and good order of communities.

It is therefore necessary that a specialized branch be established to combat agricultural related crimes and safeguard Jamaica's food security. To this end, the Agricultural Protection Branch (APB) is hereby instituted within the Jamaica Constabulary Force.

The Agricultural Protection Branch is aimed at strategically deploying specially trained and technical personnel within geographic divisions. The function of the branch will include the administration, operation, intelligence and investigation of agricultural produce crimes while adapting proactive and modern approaches to crime reduction and control in the agricultural sector.

To fulfil this mandate, The Agricultural Protection Branch will operate at the area and divisional levels with a metropolitan headquarters providing oversight of its operations leveraging available technology and stakeholder partnerships to deter, reduce, interrupt and dismantle agricultural related crimes across Jamaica.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this policy and standard operating procedures (SOPs) is to establish the framework for the administration, management and operations of the Agricultural Protection Branch of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF).

3.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedures applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the Jamaica Constabulary Force. It covers the management, administration and operations of the Agricultural Protection Branch.

4.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy of the JCF that the Agricultural Protection Branch will:

- 4.1** ensure the enforcement of laws and regulations governing agriculture;
- 4.2** collaborate with stakeholders to develop or improve safety and security measures; and
- 4.3** institute strategies to prevent and investigate agricultural produce crimes and safeguard the livelihood of farmers across Jamaica.

5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

ABIS	Agricultural Business Information System
APB	Agricultural Protection Branch
APU	Agricultural Protection Unit
AWDTs	Agricultural Warden Division Teams
DDO	Divisional Duty Officer
PECC	Police Emergency Communication Centre
MNS	Ministry of National Security
MOAFM	Ministry of Agriculture Fisheries and Mining
NAITS	National Animal Identification and Traceability System
NGO	Non-governmental Organization
SIIU	Specialized Investigation and Intelligence Unit

6.0 Definitions

6.1 Agricultural Warden

A person appointed by the Governor General, under section 3 of the *Praedial Larceny (Prevention) Act*

6.2 Drone

An Unmanned Aerial Vehicle used operationally

6.3 Operational Command

This refers to the strategic management and coordination of a mission or operation. It involves broader planning, resource allocation, and the overall supervision of a team.

6.4 Praedial Larceny

The felony created by Section 13 of the Larceny Act.

6.5 Stakeholders

Individuals or entities with an interest in the agricultural sector, or are affected by agricultural theft, such as farmers, processors, retailers and consumers.

6.6 Agricultural Produce Crimes

Categories of crime that affect the agricultural and fisheries sector.

7.0 Responsibilities

The following summarizes key responsibilities:

7.1 The Deputy Commissioner of Police in charge, Strategic Operations shall:

- 7.1.1 provide strategic oversight and policy direction on matters relating to the administration and operations of the APB.

7.2 The Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) in charge, Agricultural Protection Branch shall:

- 7.2.1 maintain oversight of all activities within the APB and geographic divisions;
- 7.2.2 conduct periodic reviews of operations to ensure sufficient personnel, proper equipment, and compliance with this policy and SOP;
- 7.2.3 provide updates periodically or as required, to the DCP Strategic Operations on the activities conducted in divisions;
- 7.2.4 establish and maintain a system for the management of key stakeholders;
- 7.2.5 ensure that personnel and resources are adequately deployed and allocated to fulfil the Branch's mandate; and
- 7.2.6 provide updates to external Liaison Officers and other relevant stakeholders and/or entities where required.

7.3 The Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) in charge Operations Agricultural Protection Branch shall:

- 7.3.1 maintain oversight of all operational activities to ensure the success of the APB's mandate;
- 7.3.2 ensure the strategic deployment of personnel to various geographic divisions;
- 7.3.3 coordinate the operational and intervention activities of AWDTs within geographic divisions in collaboration with Area and Divisional Commanders;
- 7.3.4 provide timely updates to the ACP in charge of the APB, or as required;
- 7.3.5 periodically review operational activities and adjust where necessary to achieve the APB's objectives; and
- 7.3.6 monitor the status of cases that are under investigation in accordance with organizational policies.

7.4 The Superintendent of Police (SP) in charge Administration Agricultural Protection Branch shall:

- 7.4.1 oversee the administrative functions of the APB including personnel management, resource allocation, training and compliance with policies and procedures;
- 7.4.2 provide administrative support for the planning and execution of operations; and
- 7.4.3 serve as the point of contact for internal and external communication.

7.5 The Superintendent of Police in charge Special Investigation and Intelligence Unit Agricultural Protection Branch shall:

- 7.5.1 provide intelligence and investigative support to APB enforcement actions;
- 7.5.2 track and analyse crime trends related to praedial larceny and agricultural produce crimes across areas and geographic divisions;
- 7.5.3 develop and implement crime protection, detection and investigation strategies;
- 7.5.4 implement and maintain a case management system;

- 7.5.5 manage a database of repeat offenders in collaboration with the National Intelligence Bureau;
- 7.5.6 guide the management and use of database for praedial larceny and agricultural produce crimes;
- 7.5.7 be fully aware of the various anti-theft mechanisms and related legislations for information, guidance and strategic purposes; and
- 7.5.8 report to SSP in charge of Operations APB in a timely manner or as directed.

7.6 The Deputy Superintendent of Police in charge of the Agricultural Protection Unit shall:

- 7.6.1 maintain operational oversight of the AWDTs in geographic divisions;
- 7.6.2 collaborate with the Area Operational Officer and Divisional Commanders, to formulate and implement crime prevention and mitigation strategies;
- 7.6.3 manage the deployment of AWDTs within geographic divisions;
- 7.6.4 foster partnerships with internal and external stakeholders to proactively address issues within the farming communities in the respective divisions;
- 7.6.5 initiate and/or participate in planned operational, intervention or investigative activities within geographic divisions in collaboration with Area and Divisional Commanders;
- 7.6.6 provide timely reports and updates to SSP i/c Operations APB;
- 7.6.7 provide investigative and/or technical support to divisions in collaboration with the Specialized Investigation and Intelligence Unit (SIIU), regarding the investigation of cases, as requested or deemed necessary.
- 7.6.8 collaborate with the divisional teams to initiate intervention and operational activities within the area of command to support, protect and safeguard agricultural produce and supplies
- 7.6.9 support the investigation of agricultural produce crimes; and
- 7.6.10 provide a report to the SSP i/c Operations, APB and DSP i/c Specialized Investigative & Intelligence Unit within 24 hours of a reported case of agricultural produce crime.

7.7 The Sub-Officer in charge AWDT shall:

- 7.7.1 manage the daily administrative, investigative and operational activities of the ADWT
- 7.7.2 ensure that data regarding operational and intervention activities, results, and reports under investigation are forwarded to the DSP i/c APU within 24 hours of occurrence.
- 7.7.3 report all incidents of agricultural produce crimes and their outcome to the local Station Manager or Station Supervisor and cause the appropriate entries to be made in the relevant station registers;
- 7.7.4 ensure that activities and results at the end of a tour of duty is recorded in the appropriate registers at the local station, or in unique cases, at a station within the assigned division. This information shall also be communicated to the DSP i/c APU;
- 7.7.5 immediately report incidents to PECC, the DSP i/c APU, and the Divisional Duty Officer of the assigned division, providing periodic updates throughout the tour of duty; and
- 7.7.6 initiate, coordinate and/or execute operational activities within the assigned division in keeping with the APB mandate.

8.0 Roles and Functions

- 8.1 **The Agricultural Wardens Division Teams** will consist of suitable Sub-Officers, Constables, District Constables and Agricultural Wardens who shall:
- 8.1.1 detect the breaches under the *Praedial Larceny (Prevention) Act* or the enactments specified in the *First Schedule*.
 - 8.1.2 investigate reported, suspected breaches or cases assigned in consultation with the DSP i/c APU regarding praedial larceny or agricultural produce crimes;
 - 8.1.3 perform all duties relating to the office of an Agricultural Warden by virtue of the *Praedial Larceny (Prevention) Act*;
 - 8.1.4 ensure that exhibits or property with potential evidential value are properly handled, securely stored, and disposed of in accordance with legislation and JCF policies and guidelines; and
 - 8.1.5 engage in operational activities within assigned divisions;
- 8.2 **The Sub-officer in charge Drone Units Agricultural Protection Branch** shall:
- 8.2.1 ensure the operations of Drones adhere to the *JCF Policy and Standard Operating Procedures on the Management of Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS)* and the *Jamaica Civil Aviation Authority Regulations*;
 - 8.2.2 ensure surveillance support is provided in areas prone to praedial larceny and unauthorized agricultural activities;
 - 8.2.3 coordinate and provide real-time aerial support during operations and investigations;
 - 8.2.4 conduct routine surveillance flights over high-risk areas;
 - 8.2.5 provide high-resolution video and photographs, for investigations and evidential purposes; and
 - 8.2.6 develop and maintain a database of aerial imagery for operational planning.
- 8.3 **Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC)** shall conduct the verification of RADA receipt and farmer identification by using the Agricultural Business Information System (ABIS) and other related databases.

9.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The operations of the Agriculture Protection Branch will be managed in accordance with the following guidelines:

9.1 Training and Deployment of Personnel

- 9.1.1 Personnel shall receive the required specialized training in keeping with the mandate of the APB; and
- 9.1.2 Personnel shall be strategically deployed and assigned to meet the administrative, operational and investigative demands within the branch and respective areas and divisions.

9.2 Appreciating Reports and Investigations of Agricultural Crimes

- 9.2.1 all reports of praedial larceny and agricultural produce crimes shall be assessed and investigated by the respective AWDT without undue delay and in accordance with JCF policies and relevant legislations; and
- 9.2.2 management of case files must be conducted in strict accordance with JCF policies and guidelines.

9.3 Agricultural Produce Crime Proactive Patrols

- 9.3.1 high visibility patrols shall be conducted in agricultural areas to include hot spots to deter and detect crime;
- 9.3.2 courtesy checks may be conducted on farms and information obtained to include *inter alia*, security measures in place, complaints or reports of incidents;
- 9.3.3 Vehicle stops, searches and seizures, and the questioning of suspicious individuals must adhere to legislation and JCF policies; and
- 9.3.4 visits, reports and observations made should be documented detailing, *inter alia*, timestamps, locations, descriptions of suspicious activity, nature of incident or any other relevant information.

9.4 Communication and Management of Data

- 9.4.1 The management of data must be in adherence with the *Data Protection Act*; and
- 9.4.2 appropriate registers or databases shall be kept to record all pertinent information relevant to the administrative, operational and investigative activities occurring in the respective branch, area or division.

9.5 Operations of the APB Specialized Investigation and Intelligence Unit

In an effort to enhance the investigative and intelligence capabilities of the APB in combating agricultural produce crimes, the Specialized Investigation and Intelligence Unit will be established and shall:

- 9.5.1 provide focused specialized investigative support to the APB;
- 9.5.2 investigate complex cases involving agricultural crimes, including cross-division and organized criminal activities;
- 9.5.3 develop actionable intelligence to deter and disrupt criminal networks targeting the agricultural and fisheries sector; and
- 9.5.4 ensure that investigations comply with laws and JCF policies.

9.6 Operations the of APB Drone Unit

Drone technology shall be used to monitor, survey, and secure Jamaica's farming communities and assets. The members assigned to the Drone Unit shall:

- 9.6.1 be trained in the technical use and care of UAV equipment and accessories
- 9.6.2 provide surveillance support to areas prone to praedial larceny and unauthorized agricultural activities;
- 9.6.3 provide real-time aerial support during operations and investigations by the monitoring of farms and inaccessible terrain;
- 9.6.4 conduct routine surveillance flights over high-risk areas;
- 9.6.5 support ground operations with aerial reconnaissance; and

- 9.6.6 operate in accordance with the *JCF Policy and Standard Operating Procedures on the Management of Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS)*.

10.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

- 10.1 Praedial Larceny Protection Act
- 10.2 The Agricultural Produce Act (Receipt Book System)
- 10.3 The Constabulary Force Act
- 10.4 The Country Fires Act
- 10.5 The Data Protection Act
- 10.6 The Fisheries Act, 2018(Fisheries Inspector)
- 10.7 The Larceny Act
- 10.8 The National Animal Identification and Traceability System (NAITS) Act
- 10.9 The Public Health Act (Butchers/Meat Inspection Regulations)
- 10.10 The Trespass Act
- 10.11 The Unlawful Possession of Property Act
- 10.12 The JCF Case Management Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

11.0 Relevant Records

- 11.1 Praedial Larceny Offence Register

12.0 Relevant Forms

- 12.1 The Justices of the Peace Jurisdiction Act, with the appropriate form (Schedule Form 25 (A))

Appendix 1

Agricultural Protection Branch (APB) Organizational Chart

